BT406 Mid Term Solve
Subjective

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Regards VUWAYS Team

Welcome To vuways Study Help

2 Marks Questions

What is research?

Gathering information needed to answer a question, and there by help in solving a problem..Systematic and organized effort to investigate.

Difference between dependent and independent variable .2

Dependent variable the criterion or standard by which results are judged. Assumption: changes in Y are a consequence of changes in the X.

Independent variable or Treatment The experiment has some degree of control over X.Values can be manipulated. Treatment is what researcher modifies. Term comes from medicine: a physician administers a treatment to patients

Sources of concept?

We create concepts from personal experience. Mass, speed, family. we borrow from other disciplines. W e develop a specialized jargon or terminology for a Particular subject

3 Marks Questions

What are characteristics of scientific method?

1. Empirical

Observable phenomenon

2. Verifiable

- Use senses to confirm or refute the observation.
- "Sensory experiences"
- Intuitions and revelations are out.
- Replicability needed.

3. Cumulative

- Knowledge grows.
- Need not start from scratch.

4. Deterministic

- Explains why things happen?
- Parsimony Minimum No. of variables that explain variance

Theoretical Framwork, Six Features? 3

A good theoretical framework identifies and labels the important variables in the situation that are relevant to the problem identified. It logically describes the interconnections among these variables.

1. **Examine your thesis title and research problem**. The research problem anchors your entire study and forms the basis from which you construct your theoretical framework.
2. **Brainstorm about what you consider to be the key variables in your research**. Answer the question, "What factors contribute to the presumed effect?"
3. **Review related literature** to find how scholars have addressed your research problem. Identify the assumptions from which the author(s) addressed the problem.
4. **List the constructs and variables** that might be relevant to your study. Group these variables into independent and dependent categories.
5. **Review key social science theories** that are introduced to you in your course readings and choose the theory that can best explain the relationships between the key variables in your study [note the *Writing Tip* on this page].
6. **Discuss the assumptions or propositions** of this theory and point out their relevance to your research.

Six components of theoretical framework?

1. Make an inventory of variables .(2). Give a clear explanation of why we should expect the proposed relationships to exist.(3).Make an inventory of propositions .(4).Specify the direction of relationship .(5).Arrange these propositions in a sequential order (6). Schematic diagram of the theoretical model be given

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5 Marks Questions

Difference between Exploratory and descriptive research? 5 Exploratory Research:

Initial research conducted to clarify and define the nature of the problem. Exploring a new topic. Specifically, there could be number of goals of exploratory research.

Goals of Explanatory Research:

- Explain things not just reporting. Why?
- Which explanation is better.
- Determine the accuracy of theory.
- Advance knowledge about underlying process Build and elaborate a theory complete.
- Extend a theory or principle into new areas.
- Provide evidence to support *or* refute an explanation or prediction.

Descriptive Research:

Research designed to describe characteristics of the phenomenon understudy. Helps in diagnostic analysis.

Goals of Descriptive Research:

- Describe the situation/characteristics. Provide an accurate profile of a group.
- Give a verbal or numerical picture (%).
- Present basic background information.
- Create a set of categories or classify

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Difference between cross sectional studies & longitudinal Studies? 5

The defining feature of a cross-sectional study is that it can compare different population groups at a single point in time. Think of it in terms of taking a snapshot. Findings are drawn from whatever fits into the frame. **For example** we might choose to measure cholesterol levels in daily walkers across two age groups, over 40 and under 40, and compare these to cholesterol levels among non-walkers in the same age groups. We might even create subgroups for gender. However, we would not consider past or future cholesterol levels, for these would fall outside the frame. We would look only at cholesterol levels at one point in time. However, cross-sectional studies may not provide definite information about cause-and-effect relationships.

Longitudinal Studies

The benefit of a longitudinal study is that researchers are able to detect developments or changes in the characteristics of the target population at both the group and the individual level. The key here is that longitudinal studies extend beyond a single moment in time. As a result, they can establish sequences of events.

To return to our example, we might choose to look at the change in cholesterol levels among women over 40 who walk daily for a period of 20 years. The longitudinal study design would account for cholesterol levels at the onset of a walking regime and as the walking behaviour continued over time. Therefore, a longitudinal study is more likely to suggest cause-and-effect relationships than a cross-sectional study by virtue of its scope.

3Rights of participants?

1. Deception:
2. Informed Consent:
3. Debriefing

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